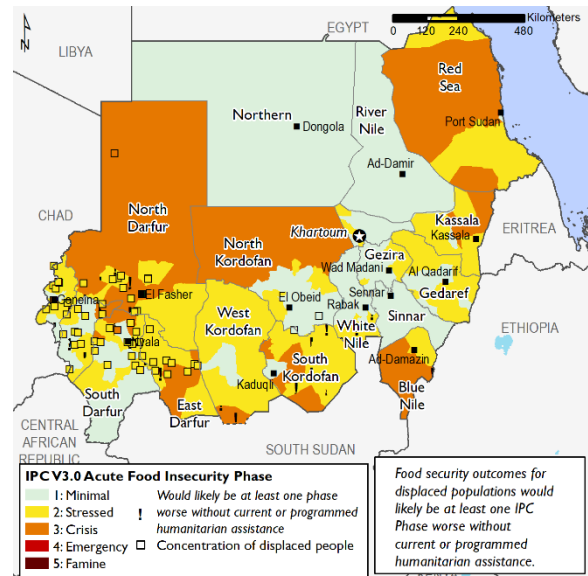


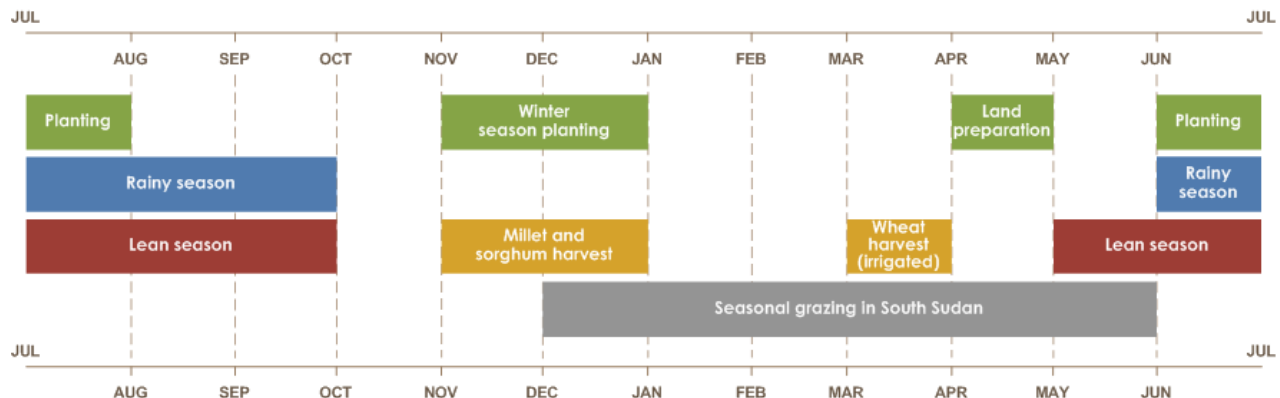
Social unrest and deteriorating macroeconomic conditions drive high food assistance needs
KEY MESSAGES

- During the June to September lean season in Sudan, food security outcomes are expected to further deteriorate and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) is expected in parts of Red Sea, Kassala, Al Gadarif, Blue Nile, West Kordofan, North Kordofan, South Kordofan, and Greater Darfur. Of highest concern are the IDPs in SPLM-N controlled areas of South Kordofan and SPLA-AW controlled areas of Jebel Marra, where Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely during the August-September peak of the lean season. Also of concern are poor households in Red Sea state.
- Food security is likely to improve seasonally with increased cereal availability from the October to January harvest. However, very poor macroeconomic conditions are expected to persist and drive extremely high food and non-food prices, resulting in overall below-average purchasing power. It is anticipated that a higher number of households than is typical will face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes through January 2020.
- The forecasted above-average June to September 2019 main rainy season has begun in some parts in eastern and western Sudan. Shortage of fuel and other inputs are reported in some of the semi-mechanized and irrigated sectors. Although this will impact cultivation somewhat, the overall area planted is expected to be only slightly below average due to the likelihood of some fuel and input assistance from the government and households' sacrificing other purchases to gain agricultural inputs. These factors coupled with favorable yields are currently expected to lead to average production, though production estimates can be made with greater confidence in the coming months as planting is fully underway.

Current food security outcomes, June 2019


Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

SEASONAL CALENDAR FOR A TYPICAL YEAR


Source: FEWS NET

NATIONAL OVERVIEW

Current Situation

The June to September main rainy season in Sudan has begun in parts of Sennar, southern Gadarif, Blue Nile, and Greater Darfur. Total rainfall as of mid-June is around 10-50 millimeters (mm) according to Climate Hazards Group InfraRed Precipitation with Station data (CHIRPS) and rainfall is broadly sufficient for planting in some areas of the traditional sector of western Sudan. Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) estimates indicate that vegetation conditions are above the median across most central areas of the country, though conditions are below the median in southern areas (Figure 1).

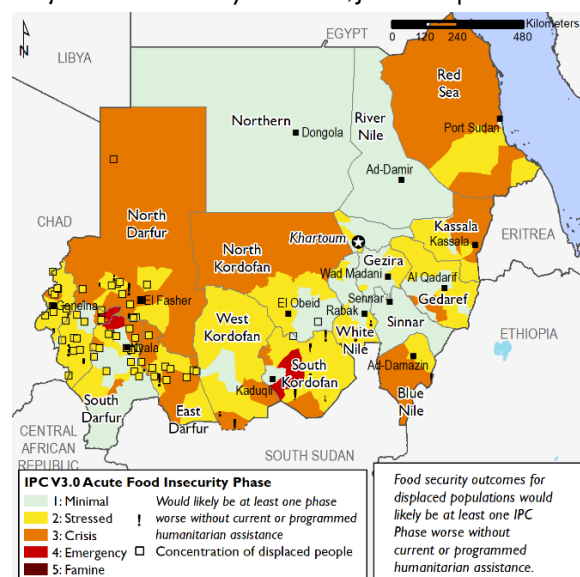
Late preparation for the 2019/2020 agricultural season is ongoing in parts of the semi-mechanized and irrigated areas of Sudan, though it is expected that shortages of cash and fuel and the high price of agricultural inputs are negatively impacting the area under cultivation. Farmers have raised concerns about these shortages and the delayed provision of inputs and finance, which are typically delivered by May.

The area targeted for cereal cultivation for the ongoing summer season is estimated at about 29,854 hectares, down from the 35,345 million hectares cultivated last year and from the 31,615 million hectares cultivated on average over the past five years. There is the possibility to expand the area under cultivation if the rains perform well, though despite efforts by the government to maximize local wheat production, the persistent fuel and cash shortages and high cost of inputs are negatively affecting the cultivation process.

Following the ousting of President Omar al-Bashir in April, civil unrest and disputes persist between the Alliance for Freedom and Change (FFC), the main opposition group leading the protests, and the Sudan's Transitional Military Council (TMC). To date a central government has not yet been established. This has resulted in an environment of uncertainty, including a prevailing hesitancy to engage in formal banking, which has in turn increased activity on the parallel market. The Sudan Central Bureau of Statistics (SCBS) has reported a slight decrease in the national inflation rate to 44.6 percent in April 2019, down from 45.4 in March and 72.9 percent in December 2018, though there is debate that the March and April figures are underestimated.

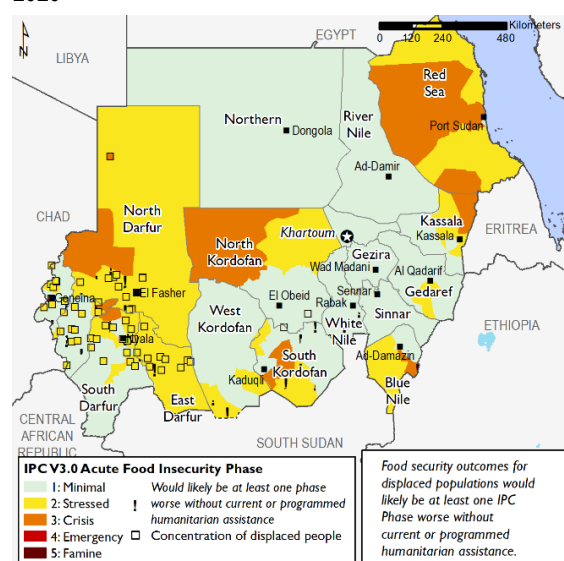
The continued shortage of hard currency and the rapid depreciation of the Sudanese Pound (SDG) have significantly reduced the ability of both the private sector and the government to import required essential food and non-food items. While the official exchange rate remains at 45 SDG/USD, the exchange rate for cash and transfers stood between 68 and 78 SDG/USD on the parallel market in May, up from 58 SDG/USD in January. Wheat flour and other imported food items and fuel and cash shortages persist across the country, the latter of which is driving up the cost of transportation to more than double that of last year. Shortages of fuel, wheat, and wheat flour also persist, and this combined with currency depreciation is driving high food prices.

Projected food security outcomes, June to September 2019



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes October 2019 to January 2020



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

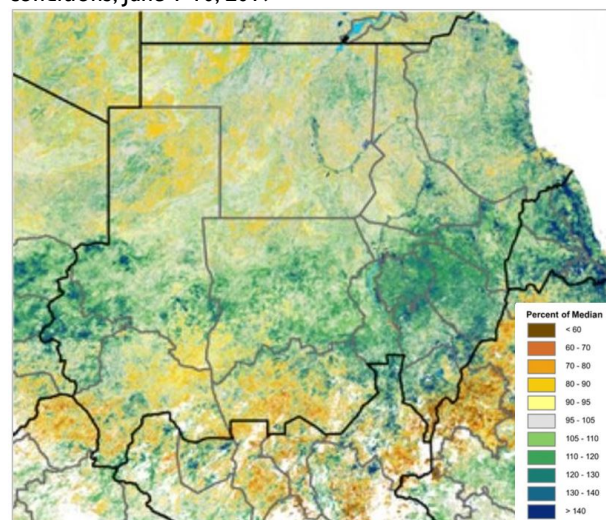
The retail prices of sorghum and millet, the main staple foods, increased between April and May across most markets in Sudan and remain almost double that of prices from the same time last year and 285-350 percent above average (Figures 2 and 3). The retail price for locally produced wheat started increasing earlier than usual in April/May, driven by increased transportation costs and shortages of wheat imports. Prices increased seasonally or remained stable through June and are currently around 150 percent above 2018 and 210 percent above the five-year average.

Livestock prices increased by 10-20 percent across most markets from April to May due to the continued demand for both export and local consumption, as well as the general price increases that are the result of the deteriorating macroeconomic situation and high cost of transportation. Livestock prices are currently around 130 percent above the same time last year and 270 percent above the five-year average. However, food prices are increasing at greater rates than livestock price increases. As a result, the livestock-to-cereal terms of trade are lower than last year and the five-year average (Figure 4).

Agricultural labor opportunities and wages have also increased, both seasonally and relative to average. Seasonal increases have occurred with land cultivation in April and May. Labor wages in April are 10-20 percent higher than March 2019, 50-70 percent above last year, and over 200 percent above the recent five-year average. However, given the more significant increase in cereal prices compared to agricultural wages, the labor wage-to-sorghum terms of trade (ToT) are also well below average.

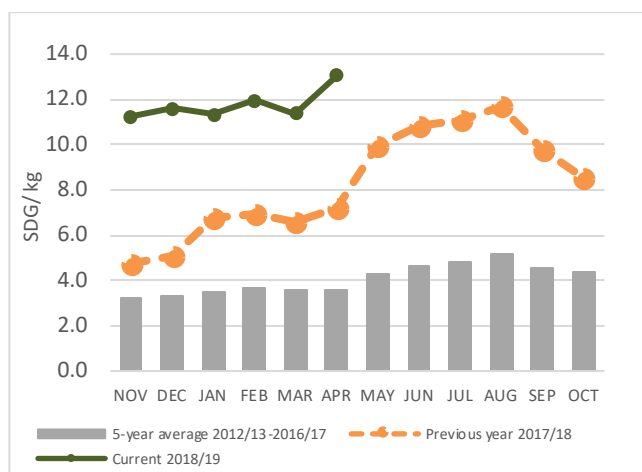
The civil unrest and disputes between the FFC and the TMC have resulted in an environment of uncertainty, political instability, and continued social unrest. However, no direct confrontations between conflicting groups have been reported in the main conflict-affected areas of South Kordofan and Blue Nile states since the 2017 ceasefire. In these areas the situation has remained relatively stable and no major displacements have occurred since beginning of 2019. In Darfur, the UN Daily Sitreps have indicated an increase in the clashes between the SLA-AW and SAF in Jebel Marra, though no large-scale, new displacements have currently occurred. According to UNHCR an estimated 1,369 South Sudanese refugees have arrived in Sudan in May 2019, bringing the total number of South Sudanese refugees in Sudan to about 849,008, of whom 11,297 arrived in 2019. UNHCR reports there have been some returnees to South Sudan in 2019 but precise figures are unknown.

Figure 1. Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) conditions, June 1-10, 2019



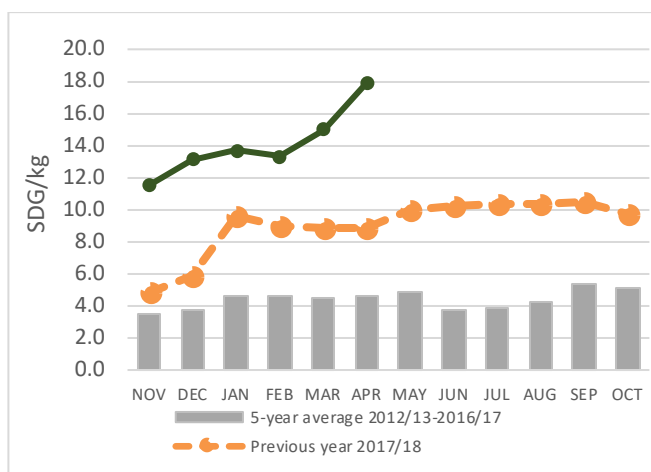
Source: USGS/FEWS NET

Figure 2. Retail prices of sorghum, Al Gadarif



Source: FAMI/FMoA data

Figure 3. Retail price of sorghum, Port Sudan



Source: FAMI/FMoA data

In May 2019, WFP provided food assistance to approximately 3.5 million beneficiaries in Sudan, through various modalities including general food distributions (GFD). Among those receiving GFD, it is estimated the average ration is between 50 and 100 percent of the required 2,100 kilocalories. Beneficiaries reached were primarily long-term IDPs in Darfur, South Kordofan, and Blue Nile, as well as South Sudanese refugees and residents in drought and conflict-affected areas in Kassala, Red Sea, Al Gadarif, North Darfur, and North Kordofan. It is anticipated that this assistance is improving food security among beneficiaries.

Based on the results of the S3M report of nutrition data collected in November 2018 and likely trend of malnutrition since, the overall national level of global acute malnutrition (GAM) by weight-for-height z-score (WHZ) is anticipated to be 'Serious' (GAM(WHZ) 10.0-14.9%), though there is likely wide variation in the severity of wasting by administrative areas. At the state level, 'Critical' (GAM(WHZ) $\geq 15\%$) levels are likely in areas where past surveys identified this level, including North Darfur, Northern, Red Sea, South Darfur, River Nile States, while 'Alert' (GAM(WHZ) 5.0-9.9%) or 'Serious' (GAM(WHZ) 10.0-14.9%) levels are likely in the remaining states. Although critical level of acute malnutrition remains possible in some localities of states with 'Serious' levels of wasting, such as Central and East Darfur, West Kordofan and Khartoum

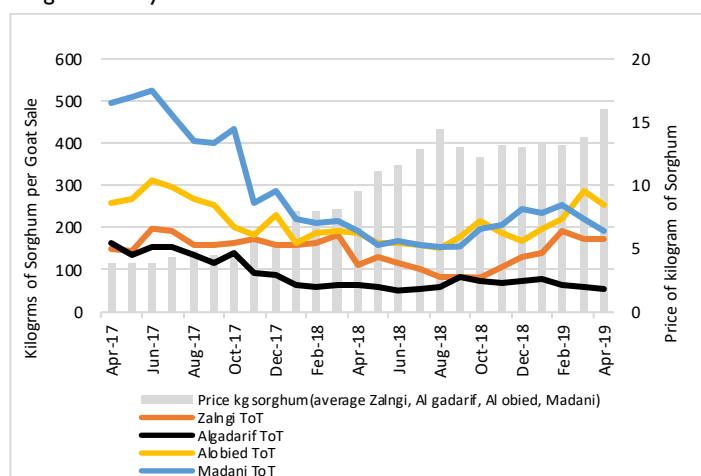
Overall, food security has deteriorated in June relative to the harvest and post-harvest periods, due to lower household food stocks and increased reliance on markets. This year, however, the political instability and persistent poor macroeconomic conditions are driving worse food security outcomes than are typical of the start of the lean season, and somewhat worse outcomes than the same time last year. This is due to the fact that the shortages of commodities and fuel and high prices are limiting households' capacity to purchase sufficient food from markets and their capacity to buy a normal level of inputs to engage in cultivation. Additionally, the high cost of non-food needs including transportation and medicine are limiting households' capacity to maintain their typical livelihoods. Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes persist in many areas while Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes exist in conflict-affected areas that also harvested below-average production last season, including: most of North Darfur state; areas hosting IDPs in Jebel Marra; SPLM-N areas of South Kordofan; and, parts of North Kordofan, southern Blue Nile, northern Kassala, and Red Sea states.

Assumptions:

The June 2019 to January 2020 most likely scenario is based on the following national-level assumptions:

- According to forecasts by NOAA and USGS, the June to September 2019 rainy season is forecast to be above average. The Sudan Meteorological Authority (SMA) and the IGAD Climate Prediction and Application Centre (ICPAC) also forecast above-average rainfall. This is likely to result in atypically high levels of flooding in flood-prone areas of Sudan, including Northern, River Nile, AL Jazeera, Sennar, and Blue Nile states. This is anticipated to destroy some crops, cause displacement, and increase the prevalence of water-borne diseases during the rainy season.
- The forecasted above-average rainfall likely to generate above-average pasture conditions and water availability. This will in turn support normal livestock body conditions and livestock production.
- Above-average rainfall is likely to support favorable crop yields in rainfed agricultural areas. The area planted in semi-mechanized and irrigated agricultural areas is likely to be negatively impacted by the current shortage of fuel and cash and high cost of inputs. Households are likely to intensify cultivation in the traditional sector to compensate for declines in semi-mechanized and irrigated production, and households are also expected to sacrifice other purchases to gain sufficient inputs to plant near normal levels. Although planting will be slightly below average, a significant decline in cultivation is not expected due to this and some government intervention with fuel and input assistance. Overall the area planted will be slightly below average and this coupled with favorable yield and interventions will likely support near

Figure 4. Goat-to-sorghum terms of trade (ToT) versus retail price of sorghum in key markets

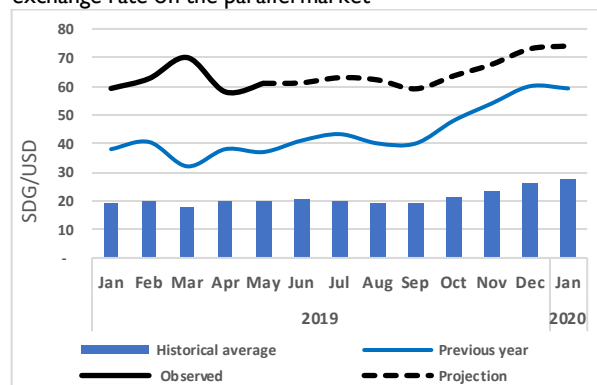


Source: FAMIS/FMoA data

average production. However, production estimates can be made with greater confidence in the coming months as planting is fully underway.

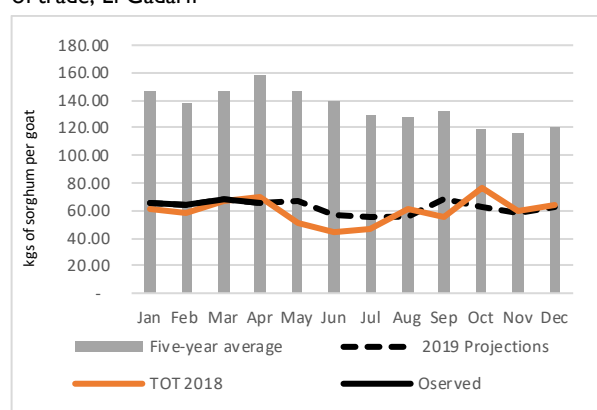
- Normal to slightly above normal agricultural labor opportunities are expected during the June to July planting period, the August to September weeding period, and the November to December harvesting period. Given the expected fuel shortage, better-off farmers likely to increase dependency on wage labor for the planting and harvesting process.
- The current political instability and social unrest in Sudan is likely to continue, and this is likely to further exacerbate the already deteriorating macroeconomic situation. Based on FEWS NET's integrated projection, the SDG/USD exchange rate is expected to continue to depreciate on the parallel market and remain around 60–80 SDG/USD through January 2020 (Figure 5). This is anticipated as a result of the likely persistent shortages of hard currency and high demand for such in order to import wheat flour, medicine, fuel, and agricultural inputs. Fuel shortages are also expected throughout the projection period.
- Based on FEWS NET's integrated price projections, the retail prices of sorghum and millet are anticipated to increase 10–20 percent through September, after which prices will seasonally decrease with the beginning of harvest in October. Overall, prices are expected to remain 30–40 percent above last year and over 300 percent above the five-year average. The price of locally produced wheat is similarly expected to remain over 300 percent above average and 75–100 percent higher than last year.
- Goat and sheep prices are expected to increase between June and July with the increased demand for local consumption and export to the Gulf States during *Haj* (pilgrimage). Prices are expected to decline slightly during the August–September peak of the lean season when market supply increases as households sell additional livestock to fund food purchases. Overall, goat and sheep prices are expected to remain 70–80 percent above last year and 270–290 percent above the five-year average. Based on the projected cereal and goat prices, goat-to-cereal ToT are anticipated to remain slightly below to that of the same period last year but 50 to 60 percent lower than the five-year average (Figure 6).
- Agricultural labor wages are expected to increase 10 to 20 percent by July and remain at these levels through end of the outlook period, staying around 100–150 percent above average, as laborers expected to demand higher wages due to local currency devaluation and rising prices of goods and services. Due to the relatively greater increase in staple food prices, though, labor-to-sorghum ToT are expected to remain 150–200 percent below average.
- In South Kordofan and Blue Nile, relative calm has persisted; however, the ongoing dispute between the Transitional Military Council (TMC) and the Freedom and Change Force (collation including main political parties, Sudanese Professionals Association, and rebel groups including SPLM-N and some of Darfur's armed groups) is likely to increase tension and direct confrontations in some areas. Periodical conflict incidents are expected to continue in Darfur, which will likely impact crop production and lead to some livestock loss. Nevertheless, the level of new internal displacement is expected to remain low, while at the same time the level of voluntary returnees is expected to be low. Overall, the number of displaced people in Sudan is expected to remain around 2.0–2.6 million.
- Arrivals of refugees from South Sudan are expected throughout the outlook period, though the rate of arrivals will be

Figure 5. FEWS NET integrated projection of SDG/USD exchange rate on the parallel market



Source: FEWS NET projection based on EI Neelain data

Figure 6. Observed and projected goat-to-sorghum terms of trade, El Gadarif



Source: FEWS NET projection based on FAMIS data

limited by poor road conditions during rainy season, relatively lower conflict in South Sudan, and the political uncertainty in Sudan. Overall, the number of new South Sudanese refugees in Sudan is expected to be low and the overall number of refugees expected to be between 850,000 and 950,000.

- Based on WFP's Operation Plan for humanitarian food assistance from June 2019 to January 2020, it is expected 3.7 million beneficiaries will be reached with over 167,000 MT and 41.7 million USD. The majority of beneficiaries are in Darfur, and the ration is expected to be greater than 50 percent of kilocalorie needs.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes:

June to September is the typical lean season in Sudan, when access to food and income is at its lowest level: households' food stock from their own production are exhausted and cereal prices are at their highest levels. Food security typically deteriorates during this time. In 2019, outcomes are expected to be more severe than usual due to the deteriorating macroeconomic conditions, political instability and social unrest, and given the fact that households will continue to face extremely high food prices and non-food prices. Accordingly, more areas within North Darfur, North Kordofan, southern Blue Nile, northern Kassala, Red Sea, and northern South Darfur are expected to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) is likely among IDPs in SPLM-N controlled areas of South Kordofan, IDPs and conflict-affected households in Jebel Mara in Darfur. 'Critical' levels of acute malnutrition (GAM(WHZ) ≥ 15%) are likely to persist in North Darfur, Northern, Red Sea, South Darfur, River Nile States, as well as in SPLM-N controlled areas of South Kordofan and Jebel Mara of Darfur and northern Red Sea state.

October 2019 to January 2020 covers the pre-harvest and harvest period in Sudan. Overall food security outcomes are expected to improve gradually in line with progression of the harvesting process. Most poor households will have access to food from their own harvests and in-kind payments from agricultural labor; wages from agricultural labor and the sale of goats will support food access from markets during a time in which staple food prices seasonally decrease. However, food security outcomes among poor households in many areas are expected to remain more severe than is typical for this time period due to continued poor macroeconomic conditions and broader political instability, which will lead to well above-average prices despite seasonal declines, and lower production in some areas. Poor households will still face difficulty purchasing many essential non-food needs and, as a result, many areas will remain Stressed (IPC Phase 2) between October 2019 and January 2020. Much of North Darfur, parts of Jebel Marra and South Kordofan, southern Blue Nile, parts of North Kordofan and West Kordofan, northern Kassala, and much of northern Red Sea states will be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) due to their high dependency on market purchase and their remoteness from areas of high production which coupled with high transportation costs will lead to some of the highest food prices in the country.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National level	An increase in political instability and social unrest that drives further conflict and deterioration in the macroeconomic situation	A significant delay in the formation of the national government risks continued instability and the ability to import essential food and non-food items. The broad instability will also threaten trust in the Sudanese Pound and risk further depreciation. This could drive even higher food prices, ultimately resulting in a higher number of people facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes.

AREAS OF CONCERN

IDPs in SPLM-N-controlled areas of South Kordofan (Figure 7) and SPLA-AW-controlled areas of Jebel Marra of Darfur States (Figure 8)

Current situation

Overall, the security situation has remained relatively calm across most parts of the main conflict-affected areas of South Kordofan. However, in Darfur, the UN Daily Sitreps have indicated an increase in the clashes between the SLA-AW and SAF

in Jebel Marra, though no large-scale, new displacements have currently occurred. As of end May 2019, access by the humanitarian community, free population movement, access to normal livelihood activities, and trade flows between Government-controlled areas and SPLM-N areas in South Kordofan and SLA-AW in Jebel Marra remained highly restricted.

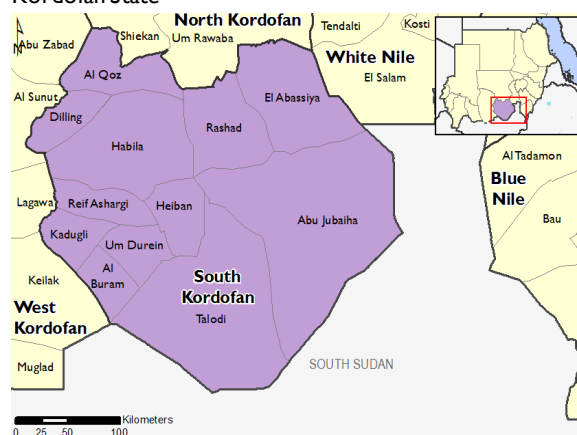
In the South Kordofan state in general, and in government-controlled areas in particular, cereal production from the 2018/19 main agricultural season was 30 percent below average according to the 2018/19 CFSAM estimates. This reduction in cereal production in South Kordofan is largely attributed to the severe shortage of fuel, cash, and agricultural inputs at beginning of the last cultivation season, resulting in a high cost of production. In SPLM-N areas, despite relatively better access to cultivation last season compared to preceding years of higher conflict, cultivation for the majority of IDPs continues to be limited to a *jubra* (home gardens) due to limited access to main farming lands and the scarcity and extremely high prices of agricultural inputs. Therefore, overall production among IDPs remained far below that of the pre-conflict years, and below-average food availability at the household and market level persist in South Kordofan.

Staple food prices atypically increased between February and May. In Kadugli main market of South Kordofan, the retail price of sorghum increased 22 percent between March and April and remained 110 percent above last year and over 250 percent above the recent five-year average. In SPLM-N areas prices remained 50-60 percent above prices in government areas due to trade restrictions and the high cost of transportation. In Zalingi market, adjacent to Jebel Marra, there was a slight decrease in sorghum prices between March and April, though prices remain over 200 percent above average due to the high cost of transportation and deteriorating macroeconomic situation. Prices are estimated to be nearly doubled in SLA-AW held areas of Jebel Marra due to relatively low local production and restricted trade flows from government areas.

Livestock prices also continued to increase in most markets including conflict-affected areas of Darfur and South Kordofan, but prices are increasing at a lower rate than that of cereal prices. Between March and April, goat prices increased 5-10 percent in both Kadugli and Zalingi markets, driven by local currency depreciation. Goat prices in April remained 80-90 percent above last year and 200-230 percent above the five-year average. In general, livestock prices in SPLM-N areas and areas hosting IDPs in Jebel Marra remained far below prices in respective government-controlled areas due to restricted trade flows and limited marketing opportunities.

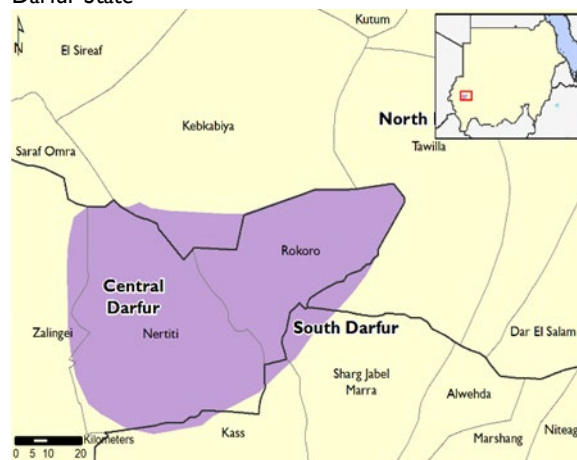
In Kadugli market of South Kordofan and Zalingi market near Jebel Marra, goat-to-sorghum ToT decreased by 10-20 percent between March and April, as result of the greater increase in sorghum prices than the increase in livestock prices. Overall,

Figure 7. Area of concern reference map, South Kordofan State



Source: FEWS NET

Figure 8. Area of concern reference map, Jebel Marra, Darfur State



Source: FEWS NET

these ToT remain slightly below last year and the recent three-year average. The labor wage-to-sorghum ToT dropped 38 percent between March and April also due to sorghum price increases while labor wages remained stable.

Based on the recent S3M survey conducted in South Kordofan in 2018, the level of acute malnutrition vary across the state with 'Acceptable' levels in Delami at 3.32 percent (0.98-7.21) and ElLeri at 4.76 percent (2.51-9.55), 'Alert' levels in Dilling at 6.75 percent (3.65-10.93) and 'Serious' levels in Talodi at 13.40 percent (3.75-21.34). In Central Darfur, 'Critical' levels were recorded in North Jebel Mara 20.75 percent (9.98-27.59) and 'Serious' in central Jebel Mara at 12.30 percent (4.99-18.44) and Nertiti at 12.84 percent (8.71-16.66).

IDPs in SPLM-N controlled areas of South Kordofan and IDPs in Jebel Mara area of Darfur continue to have limited access to their typical food and income sources due to displacement, restricted population movements, restricted trade flows, and high loss of household assets. Additionally, they currently have lower than normal food access given well below-average purchasing power amidst ongoing macroeconomic deterioration. To cope with the situation, it is expected that IDPs periodically face food consumption gaps and engage in negative coping strategies in an effort to meet their basic food needs. In SPLM-N areas of South Kordofan, IDPs are likely spending more of their income on food, cut down on non-food expenses such medical expenses, send young children to work or live with relatives in government-controlled areas, and increase dependency on remittances from family members outside the area. It is expected these populations are facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) acute food insecurity.

Assumptions

In addition to the above national-level assumptions above, projected outcomes for IDPs in SPLM-N areas of South Kordofan and SPLA-AW areas of Darfur are based on the following assumptions:

- Restriction to free population movements, trade flows, and access to typical livelihood activities are likely to continue, which will result in below-average access to income and food sources.
- It is expected that humanitarian actors will continue to face access restrictions to areas hosting IDPs in Jebel Marra and SPLM-N areas of South Kordofan throughout the scenario period due to insecurity and restrictions by government authorities. IDPs are likely to remain in their areas of displacement with no or limited access to their areas of origin during scenario period.
- Cereal prices in these areas are anticipated to remain 110-130 percent above last year and 250-300 percent above the five-year average, though following seasonal trends increasing through September and decreasing between October and January. The trend in SPLM-N of South Kordofan and Jebel Mara in Darfur is similar, though prices will remain at levels 50-60 percent higher than in government-controlled areas.

Most likely food security outcomes

Food access among IDPs in the two areas is likely to reduce during the June to September period, particularly during August and September, the peak lean season. During this time income earning opportunities are seasonally very low. The fact that prices are significantly above average will restrict household food access more than is typical during the lean season. Given persistent access restraints, humanitarian food assistance is unlikely during this time and many IDPs will face extreme difficulty to meet their basic needs and experience large food consumption gaps indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4) during August and September. Food security is likely to improve between October and January given expected better access to food from own production, in-kind payments from agricultural labor, and the seasonal increase in wild foods availability. However, though access to the latter will improve, access to food is likely to remain low due to the anticipated very high prices of cereal and non-cereal food items. Most IDPs are expected to continue earning limited amounts of income from sales of forestry products and remittances, though this income will be insufficient for poor households to purchase all of their basic food needs. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected during this time.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
SPLM-N areas of South Kordofan and SLA-AW areas in Jebel Mara	A sustained high level of direct clashes and confrontations between conflicting parties	There are indications conflict has increased somewhat and sustained high levels of conflict would likely further disrupt access to livelihood activities including cultivation and harvesting. Further displacement would also be likely. Overall, more IDPs would likely face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes across seasons.

The Eastern Khors Agropastoral Zone (SD-05) in Alguna, Oleep, Gebeit Maadin, Halayib, and Dordeib, of the Red Sea state (Figure 8)

Four localities in the north and southwest of Red Sea state constitute the area of concern: Alguna/Oleep, Gebeit Maadin, Halayib, and Dordeib. These localities are mostly under the Eastern Khors Agropastoral livelihood zone of eastern Sudan where crops are grown more or less entirely for household consumption, goats provide milk and are sold to fund food and non-food purchases, and unskilled labor and traditional gold mining are among the main income sources for the poor households. Poor households represent 60-70 percent of the population in the zone.

Current Situation

The four localities of concern harvested far below average production during the 2018/19 main agricultural season due to poor performance of the rainy season. The area started sourcing cereal from main producing centers in other parts of Sudan two months earlier than is typical. Staple food prices have increased unseasonably in main markets due to poor production and currency depreciation: in Port Sudan main market, sorghum prices increased 19.4 percent between March and April following an increase of 12.5 percent between February and March. The price of sorghum in April stood at more than doubled the respective 2018 price and almost three times the recent five-year average. In rural markets in the areas of focus the price of sorghum also increased on average 20-25 percent between March and April and are 20-35 percent above prices in Port Sudan main market due to the high cost of transportation and limited market supplies in rural markets.

Livestock prices followed the same overall increasing trend driven by currency depreciation, though the increase in livestock prices were at relatively lower rate of increase in comparison to cereal price increases. In Port Sudan market, sheep prices increased 10-15 percent between March and April and are almost 200 percent above last year and the five-year average, though prices are relatively lower in rural markets of areas of concern due to fairly low demand. The sheep-to-sorghum ToT dropped 14 percent between March and April given the relatively higher food price increase and the ToT are also 60 percent below last year.

Poor households typically own 1-3 hectares for traditional cultivation and the majority of them have started land preparation, though access to agricultural inputs are inadequate due to reduced availability and high prices of seeds, tools, and fuel. However, traditional gold mining remains a main income source for poor households and youth from poor households are likely extending their period of work in gold mines. Ground information indicates wages from this source of income are near normal.

Recent S3M survey conducted in Red Sea state showed 'Critical' (15.0-29.9%) levels of acute malnutrition in three of four counties of concern with a GAM (WHZ) prevalence of 22.26 percent (13.12-33.82) in Halayeb, 21.98 percent (13.58-35.79) in Dordeib, and 16.04 percent (8.27-23.72) in Gabaot Elma-aadin. The survey recorded a 'Serious' GAM (WHZ) prevalence of 12.67 (7.41-19.20) in Elguna Elawlait.

Poor households in Alguna, Oleep, Gebeit Maadin, Halayib, and Dordeib of the Red Sea state are currently facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes due to reduced access to food from own production and reduced access to market purchases as result of the extremely high prices of cereal. More poor households are facing small food consumption gaps or engaging in negative coping to meet their basic food needs.

Assumptions

In addition to the above national-level assumptions above, projected outcomes for Alguna, Oleep, Gebeit Maadin, Halayib, and Dordeib of Eastern Khors Agropastoral Livelihood Zone in Red Sea State are based on the following assumptions:

Figure 8. Area of concern reference map, Red Sea State



Source: FEWS NET

- Poor households are likely to cultivate less than the typical 1-3 hectares due to the high costs of cultivation.
- Agricultural labor opportunities are expected to increase seasonally between June and September and total income from this source will likely be normal as better-off households are expected to hire at normal levels despite macroeconomic difficulties.
- Excessive flooding in the khors (seasonal rivers) is expected to destroy some crops, though the overall impact is not expected to be large-scale.
- Based on FEWS NET's integrated price projection, cereal prices in Port Sudan main market are anticipated to be 50-60 percent above last year and 250-270 percent above the five-year average through October. Prices will likely decrease seasonally between November and January; however, prices will remain at least 30-40 above last year and 160-180 percent the five-year average. Prices in rural markets of areas of concern are expected to remain 20-30 percent above respective in Port Sudan and main areas of production of eastern Sudan.
- Livestock disease is expected to increase seasonally, particularly at the peak of the milking season (July-September 2019), reducing milk production somewhat, though this is seasonally normal.
- Poor households are expected to increase engagement in labor migration to gold mines. This will reduce the labor available for agricultural production somewhat, resulting in a delay of the harvest and some crop losses.

Most likely food security outcomes

Poor households in Algunab, Oleep, Gebeit Maadin, Halayib and Dordieib of the Red Sea state are likely to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes during peak lean season between June and September 2019 due to reduced access to food from their own production and reduced access to market purchases as result of the of the extremely high prices of cereal. Poor households are expected to reduce the number of meals they consume daily and depends on wild foods, while others will migrate to gold mines and urban areas (Port Sudan) in search of labor opportunities. Some households will also likely increase the sale of livestock and some may exhaust their ownership of small ruminants. However, many are still expected to face food consumption gaps. Food security is likely to improve during the pre-harvest and harvest period of October to January, as access to own production and in-kind payments are expected to increase. Nevertheless, poor households are usually reliant on markets to meet their basic food needs and the extremely high prices among limited labor opportunities will continue to restrict households' capacity to purchase sufficient food to meet their energy requirements and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are likely to persist.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
Eastern Khors Agro pastoral Zone (SD-05), Algunab, Oleep, Gebeit Maadin, Halayib and Dordieib)	Far below-average 2019/20 harvest	Food prices would further increase, and households would have minimal production in late 2019. The number of people facing Crisis (IPC phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) would increase.

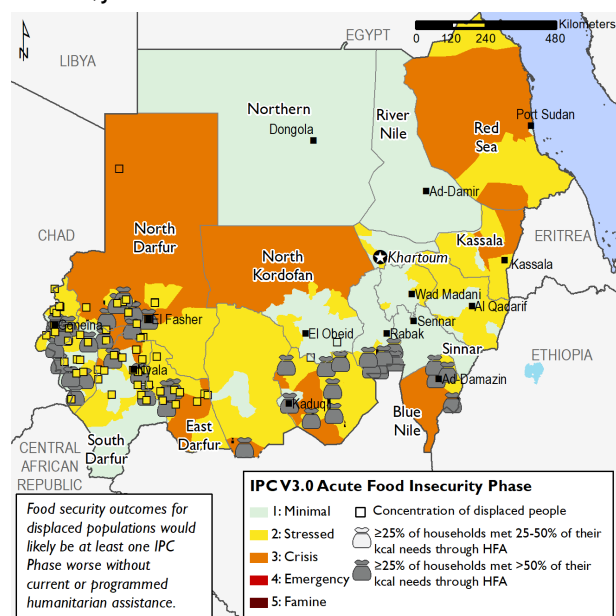
ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. [Learn more here.](#)

MOST LIKELY FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES AND AREAS RECEIVING SIGNIFICANT LEVELS OF HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE*

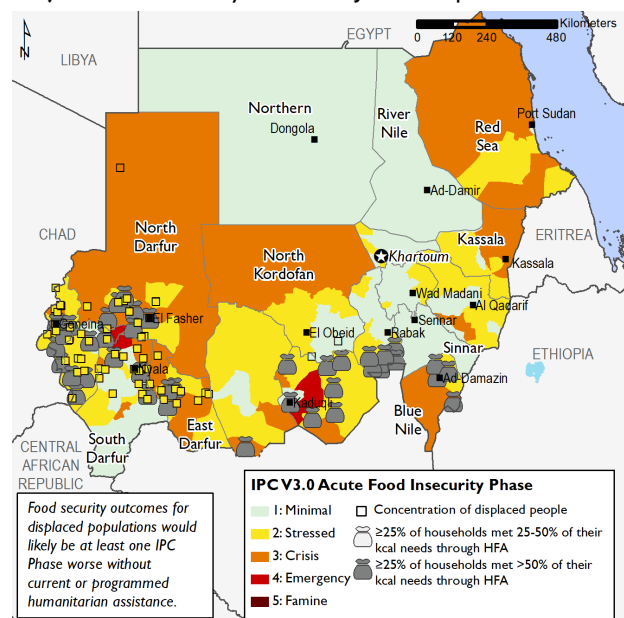
Each of these maps adheres to IPC v3.0 humanitarian assistance mapping protocols and flags where significant levels of humanitarian assistance are being/are expected to be provided. The symbol  indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average 25–50 percent of caloric needs from humanitarian food assistance (HFA).  indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average over 50 percent of caloric needs through HFA. This mapping protocol differs from the (!) protocol used in the maps at the top of the report. The use of (!) indicates areas that would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of current or programmed humanitarian assistance.

Current, June 2019



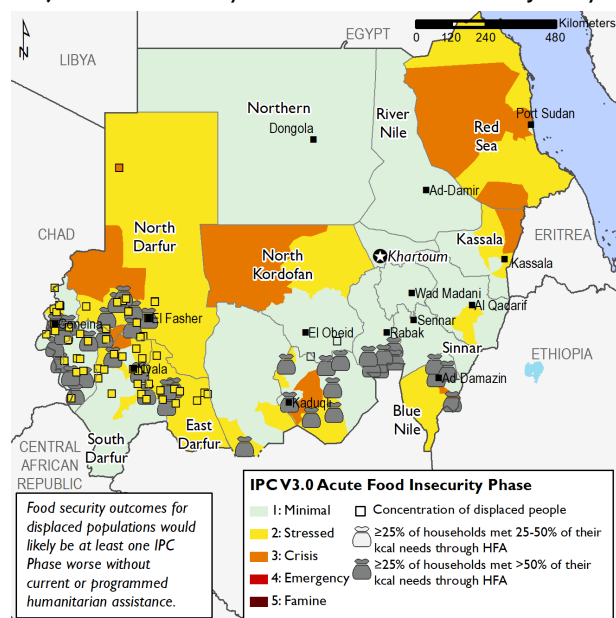
Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, June to September 2019



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, October 2019 to January 2020



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

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